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AFRICAN VISION MALAWI

CREATING LASTING CHANGE

Issue 38

Newsletter
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Charity no
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Our Vision: A healthy, educated, self-sufficient community in Malawi

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Join our 500km cycle challenge in May 2025

20 Years of African Vision Malawi!



In 2005, we took our first tentative steps in creating a charity to bring about a healthy, educated and self-sufficient community in Malawi. Since then, we have been driven by a passion to empower young people, improve health, and strengthen communities. One of our proudest achievements is Sam's Village, a residential training facility which has already trained over 300 vulnerable adults with a variety of vocational skills including Carpentry, Tailoring, Solar installation, Mechanics and Basic Electronics.

We work in an area 30km from Malawi's capital city, Lilongwe. The area spans 400km^2 with a local population of 60,000.

We have also forged lasting partnerships with 46 schools in both Malawi and the UK, impacting over 10,000 students through improved infrastructure, sanitation facilities, and access to quality education.

As we mark this milestone anniversary, we are filled with gratitude for the lives we have touched and the progress we have made together. Here's to the next 20 years of creating a brighter future for Malawi! Join us on some of our exciting fundraisers!

SAM'S VILLAGE —

Our grateful thanks to the **Bloom Foundation** who have provided £30,000 for Vocational & Life skills Training at Sam's Village. We have trained 50 people in Motorbike mechanics and Basic Electronics with Baking coming up in February. This enables marginalised people to learn a basic skill to then start up in business and become self-sufficient. (photos right)



Gold Youth visit— In August we welcomed Desire Luke, the Chief Programme Operations Officer from Gold Youth. Over three days our team facilitated introductions to some of our beneficiaries and visits to our programmes. We look forward to working with them in the future. (photos below)







HEALTH -

We work in partnership with Love Support Unite (LSU) who fund some of our Health programmes. The **Medical Outreach** programme to 10 rural villages is literally a life saver and supported over 32,000 people last year! We had funds to support our Disability Programme from **Foundry International** which supported our monthly outreach programme and provided wheelchairs to 12 beneficiaries, (photo below) along with resources for our first SEND (Special Educational Needs & Disability) unit. All life changing for our beneficiaries.

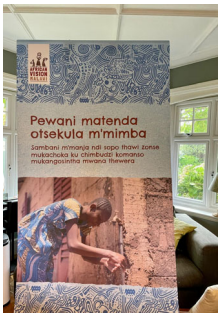


Our **Dentistry programme** ran in November where 2,000 children in five schools were screened. Dental hygiene was provided along with 600 fillings and extractions. This programme is in partnership with the Lilongwe District is funded by LSU. (photos right)



SMU (Safe Motherhood Unit) and SEND (Special Educational Needs & Disability) unit. The building is practically finished with a few areas to focus on in January. It is exciting that it will soon be used. Our grateful thanks to all involved in this build. Thanks to **Anna Pearson** who designed the educational blinds to go in the SMU, which will get to Malawi in April. (photos below left)









STAFF & VOLUNTEERS— Marie Brown—Sadly we say goodbye to Marie (photo right) who has been with AVM for the past 4 years. She has gone to manage Lilongwe Wildlife Trust. We appreciate all the support she has given to us over the past 4 years and wish her well in her new career. Heather Palmer returns to being CEO.



Oscar Chunda— has stepped up from Operations Manager to be our Country Manager and we have every confidence that he will make positive changes for AVM during 2025.

Isaac Mgeni—joins us to be Sam's Village Manager from January 2025. We welcome him and look forward to the skills he brings to the role. (photo right)



Walter Malikezi—our Njewa Permaculture Officer has recently been certified to train people in making biofertilizer. He has already been supporting us with training in the rural area and is a great asset to our team. (photo bottom right)





Team Programme & Budget planning—a lot of work goes into preparing the programmes and budgeting for the next financial year. This year we took the team to Sol Farm in Lilongwe for concentrated time with focus and fun! (photos left)



EDUCATION



Early Childhood Development (ECD) - We have successfully piloted 5 sustainable ECD community gardens and we are now extending these to 9 gardens. 1,000 children aged under 5, will get fed 5 days a week with nutritional porridge at our centres. The community, trained to grow the gardens also learn how to make soap as an income generator. Thanks to **Gandys International** who provided Christmas lunch and fun to Funsani in December! (photos right)



School Partnerships - Our grateful thanks to **Sarah Parsloe** and **Philippa Hocking** who went to Malawi in October to do our 22 partnership visits. An enormous task that they performed with joy and laughter. The theme was 'food and growing' and packs from the UK were shared with individual schools. 2025 theme is 'Homes and Animals'. (photos below)

Scholarship programme— We currently have 43 students at University and 32 have already graduated over the years. 25 are at Secondary and 4 are at Primary. An enormous 'thank you' to all our sponsors who support students and change their lives positively by getting them out of poverty. The Scholarship camp was held at Sam's Village from 27th - 30th December where the theme was 'Resilience in times of change'.







SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE— Our partnership with **SCOPE Malawi** strengthens as they support us with permaculture gardens and nutritional cooking demonstrations at our newly built Safe Motherhood Unit. We are very excited about this new project which will include local people to help train up new mothers in permaculture techniques, passing on valuable information.



In October our Chitsime community of farmers joined the SCOPE **Malawi Sustain Fest** to show others what we are growing in our area. All farmers are now food secure which is incredible! (photo below left)



AVM sustainability—Both at Sam's Village and Njewa office we have great permaculture gardens to sustain our team and programmes. (photos right)

30 new beneficiaries have been trained over the year in **Dimba gardens** by river beds. The money they make from selling produce helps towards buying orphans clothing, school fees etc. We currently have 70 Household permaculture gardens supporting marginalised families with gardens beside their homes.

Last year we planted 13,000 trees and this year aim to plant a further 10,000 in the community. (photo bottom right)







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TINA WALKER

Earth Building work - Our Safe Motherhood Unit (SMU) and SEND (Special Educational Needs & Disability) unit are nearly completed. (photo below right) We intend to open the building officially in April. It is earth-built with compressed blocks by **Let's Build It.** Our grateful thanks to all people who have contributed to funding this build and particularly to **Aoife Donnelly,** the architect and **Rumbani Chihana** our consultant.

Songwe Primary rammed earth built classrooms—we have been partnered with Clemens Dieterich from 'Opportunities through Education' who have funded this school block and The Mall School also raised funds to support this build and feeding programme. The ICIM (Malawi building regulators) are monitoring the build and we anticipate it will be accredited by the Lilongwe District and then allow Clemens to build more blocks in Mzuzu area in the north of Malawi.







FUNDRAISING EVENTS

Events coming up:

500km cycle challenge 2025—Will be held from May 23rd - June 3rd. Not a race, but an incredible experience of seeing Malawi by bicycle and some of our programmes. £1,750 includes everything in Malawi, cycle hire, transport and support, safari, seeing cave paintings, food, accommodation and fun! (excludes flights). If you are interested contact heather.palmer@africanvision.org.uk to secure your place. Details on our website here

Retreat to the Farm—10% of the profit comes to AVM. Check out the website for upcoming retreats in the summer. https://www.retreattothefarm.co.uk/

Climb Mount Snowdon— as many times in 24 hours as you can! September 6th 2025. You can also climb it just once or even add other challenges on to make it harder! We are partnering with Love Support Unite (LSU) for this fundraiser and would love to have 20 people to celebrate our 20th anniversary!

If you are taking part in a marathon, triathlon or other challenge this year, why not think about sponsoring African Vision Malawi and be part of our journey in changing lives in Malawi.

We are thankful to **Halcrow Foundation** for providing a grant of £8,300 to support our Safe Motherhood Unit project. Building bicycle ambulances and providing nutritional packs to new mothers.

We have had an incredible donation of £20,000 which will support our 'Girls Education Matters', 'SEND project' and 'Vocational training start ups'.

Past events:

Ladies night—November 2024 Thanks to the 40 people that joined us at the Waggon and Horses pub in Surbiton for a 'fun evening' which raised £1,300 for our female focused programmes .